



Footprints

Walking with the marginalized

Annual Magazine | 2024-2025

Province Development Office - Jesuit Madurai Province

Our Projects

1

Empowering students through technical eco-projects.
Training students to healing from deserving.

2

through evening education.
Emancipating dalit become agents of addiction.

3

study centres.
Caring for our common and tribal children and environmental protection.
Ensuring better

4

Transforming the youth home through sustainable women.
Providing holistic facilities for the most

Table of Contents

Message from Fr. Provincial
Empowering Dalit Children Through Education
02 Construction of Multipurpose Halls
03 Evening Study Centres - A platform for development
04 Equipping the dining hall facilities
05 ■Empowering Girl Children Through Education
- Fr. Vargheesh Antony, S. J.,
06 Promoting and Advocating the Rights of Nature by widows and students
07 ■Transforming the youth
- Fr. Kulandaisamy, S.J.,
08 Improved infrastructural facilities for Trainees
09 ■A ministry with a difference
- Fr. Francis Jayapathy, S. J.,



Training Students in Organic Farming and Sustainable Agriculture
■Eco-Consciousness: Need of the hour
- Fr. Ignacimuthu, S. J.,
Developing an Eco-sanctuary
Empowering the Children & Women of Dalit and Tribal communities
Renovation of Inigo Boys' Home
■Shaping the present for the future of the tribal communities
- Fr. Anthony James, S.J.
Training the poor students through technical education
Unearth the Hidden Treasures
Training students to be Agents of Environmental Protection and Organic Farming
Renovation of Wenish Apostolic Home
20 A few glimpses through the lens...

Message from Fr. Provincial...!



01

Dear Friends.,
serve. Unfortunately, the impact of our mission remains unnoticed and rarely documented. The annual noteworthy that our men in these difficult places reach out to the most deserving with utmost sincerity and all our friends who have partnered in our mission in their respective places for the

02

Greetings!
magazine of the Province Development Office captures those impactful interventions made in the lives of unwavering commitment to empower our people. I congratulate all our dear friends who have written these articles. make your footprints more meaningful in the lives of others.

03

It gives me immense joy to learn that the Province Development Office is coming out with the Annual the people in and through our projects. We reach out to the children, women, youth, widows and those in The annual magazine, "Footprints", carries not only our initiatives and interventions but also a few insightful

04

Magazine titled, "Footprints: walking with the marginalized." It is indeed an apt title as our mission has left most need who are not recognized by the mainstream society. In the recent years, we have been more and inspiring articles written by Jesuits who are stalwarts in their respective fields. Hence, besides giving

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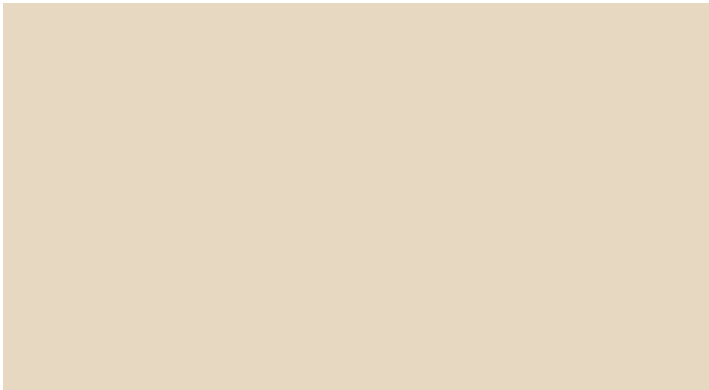
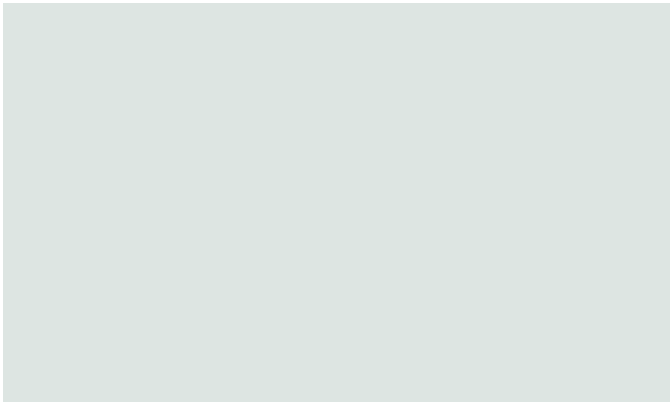
behind indelible footprints in the lives of the poorest of the poor whom we serve. We serve in remote places ecologically conscious and some of our initiatives aim at protecting the environment. Our grassroots the readers an update on the implementation of the programs, the magazine will offer the readers more

06

in and through our social action centres and there are great impacts made in the lives of those whom we initiatives by our social action centres are directly connected to the struggles of the people and it is truly insights into various themes to ponder over. I acknowledge the hard work, commitment and generosity of

Chapter 01 Empowering Dalit Children Through Education

To improve and strengthen the learning skills and educational performance of every child.
To provide free evening tuition classes for children who are unable to pay and attend private classes.
To support economically disadvantaged families by assisting their children in pursuing



learning environment.
To ensure that all children continue their education without dropping out at any stage.
To create awareness among students about higher education opportunities and guide them in selecting suitable courses.

Children’s Day:

The CHILDREN'S DAY celebration for the academic and evening class teachers from 60 villages "DISCIPLINE BRINGS ELEVATION." The students poetry, essays, singing, and sports competitions. celebration discipline, confidence, and potential of the students Inauguration of Multi-Purpose Halls: centre MULTI-PURPOSE HALLS, fulfilling a long-standing by sitting on the floor in public spaces, often facing comfortable, and inspiring learning environment. season, and offers a supportive atmosphere for their milestone in our mission to uplift rural students and towards a brighter future. opportunities for all children,

year 2025–2026 was held at the AMUTHU centre on participated in the event and made it memorable. enthusiastically showcased their talents through This highlighted of AMUTHU centre, making it a memorable and The proudly need for children in the villages where the centre discomfort and weather challenges. Understanding This new facility ensures that children can study academic and personal growth. The construction create better learning opportunities for every child, Reducing educational inequality regardless of their background.

10.08.2025 with great success. A total of 250 students The celebration was organized under the theme various events such as dance, drama, mime, remarkable the successful event. AMUTHU inaugurated serves. Until now, the students had been learning this need, AMUTHU centre built halls to provide a safe, without interruption, especially during the rainy of multi-purpose halls stands as a meaningful marking a significant step forward in their journey by providing equal learning

The CHILDREN'S DAY celebration for the academic

Quiz Competition:

1

The first round of the quiz competition for the was where AMUTHU centre operates enthusiastically interest academic perform been to think critically, stay curious, and improve their My name is Shobana and I am from Odaipatti. Since my school days, I have Following that, I continued my higher education in Tirunelveli. With the from AMUTHU, which greatly helped me in paying my academic fees under a practicing lawyer. I am grateful to AMUTHU for being a

2

academic successfully participated, and excellence, confidently in school and beyond. This initiative, conducted learning skills. The event stood as a proud success, been a student at the evening study centre run by AMUTHU. After completing continued support of AMUTHU, I enrolled in the Government Law and hostel expenses. AMUTHU played a crucial role in helping me significant part of my educational journey and success. I express The project is supported by the generosity of our friends from

3

year conducted at the AMUTHU centre. Students from showcasing talents. The main purpose of this competition is helping which consistently encouraging young minds to grow sharper, more my schooling, with the support of AMUTHU, I pursued my undergraduate College, Tirunelveli, and completed my law degree as well. Throughout complete my education without any interruption. Today, I have my sincere thanks to the organization for their continuous support.

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2025–2026 the evening learning centres across the villages their to strengthen children's general knowledge and them has throughout the year, continues to inspire students confident, and better prepared for a bright future. degree at MVM college in Dindigul and successfully completed it. my school and college education, I received educational scholarships completed my law studies and I am currently undergoing training Ms. Shobana Testimonies...

Chapter 02 Construction of Multi-Purpose Halls

Implementing Institution:

Amuthu Charitable Public Social Educational and Environmental Trust.

Short Description of the Project:

The ultimate objective of building multipurpose halls in AMUTHU social action centre was to increase

students' participation and creating platform for the villagers for their social activities. As we have completed

the project of constructing the halls, we are hopeful that these halls will benefit a large number of students

and the poor villagers. More students can now have a roof over their heads and more particularly they can

study in an amiable environment. The halls also have black board

facilities which could help the students

learn better from the tuition teachers.

With the new facilities...

Students' academic

performance will be

improved.

Gradually students'

“

enrollment in the schools
will go high.

AMUTHU children would have
these halls at their disposal for
many years to come.

There will be good support
from the people and this
will help them celebrate
their togetherness.

Students will feel less
distracted and enjoy more
study environment.

The tuition teachers can make
use of these halls for a long
time to conduct lessons.

Goals Achieved by the Project:

01

The new multipurpose halls at present provide out with utmost sincerity to give the best to our very happy about the entire project. has been providing educational support and services to these children, a milestone for our village, and it will serve as a lasting asset for Ms. Meena

02

a space for students of those villages to gather target people. We have handed over the halls with My name is Meena, and I reside in Semmadai village. I have completed helping them in their studies and encouraging their academic growth. the educational development of our children. We are deeply Testimonies...

03

for particularly evening tuition to complete their required facilities. On the day of the inauguration, my B.A., in English Literature and am currently working as an evening Thanks to Amuthu Centre's efforts, our village has now received a new grateful to Amuthu Centre and our donors from Nuremberg and The construction of multi-

04

school given home works. This makes a sense the Province Treasurer and the PDD visited all the study center staff member at Amuthu Centre. Our village is home to community hall. This facility has been constructed with the purpose Switzerland for this initiative, and we are confident that it will make purpose halls stands as a

05

of unity among them. The Jesuits in charge of centres and were happy with the results of the approximately 70 families, and all the children in our area are enrolled in of providing a dedicated, comfortable space for children and young a real difference in the academic achievements of the children meaningful milestone in our

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the project ensured that all the works are carried project. They spoke to the people and they were government schools and colleges. For the past five years, Amuthu Centre people to sit and study. The construction of the community hall is in our community. mission to uplift rural students

My name is Krithik Vijay, and I am currently pursuing my college studies. I live

in E. Kallupatti, a village where Amuthu Centre has been actively involved in educational initiatives for the past ten years. Over the years, Amuthu Centre has made remarkable contributions to improve the educational prospects of the children in our village, and this year, we are fortunate to have received an even greater benefit – a new community hall built through the efforts of Amuthu Centre because of the generosity of our donors. This community hall is of immense value to us because, until now, there were no public spaces available in our village where children could sit and study, nor were there any areas where college students could gather to study. Thanks to Amuthu Centre, this building has been constructed, providing an ideal space for students to study in a quiet, comfortable, and conducive environment. We thank Amuthu Centre and our donors for their vision and commitment to improving the lives of people in our village, and we are confident

in our area have been receiving educational assistance year after year, helping them in their studies and overall development. This new community hall represents a significant step toward the development of our village. It is a symbol of progress, providing a modern and conducive environment for our children, students, and youth to study and prepare for various competitive exams. The youth in our village are now using the hall to prepare for government exams, which is a positive change. It has become a focal point for learning and community activities, benefiting everyone in our village. We are very grateful for this initiative, as it will continue to benefit the children, students, and people of our village for many years to come. I am grateful to Jesuiten Weltweit, Nuremberg and our

Chapter 03 Evening Study Centres – A platform for development

Dalit children in rural India particularly in the remote the SC/ST (Scheduled Caste/Scheduled Tribe) of resources, etc. All these constrains significantly activities like sports, cultural events, etc., is an most of the schools are deprived of this important in the schools but also in their own homes. Many of The lack of physical facilities, unhealthy living distracted and occupied. Their parents are usually These are some of the painful factors that de- Short Description of the Project: children in south Tamil Nadu who are deprived of DACA with the continued and generous support of of South Tamil Nadu (Madurai, Ramnad, Sivagangai, Madurai, Muthukulathur, Sattur and Tirunelveli.

villages of Tamil Nadu have mostly limited access welfare-board schools. These schools have poor hinder the Children's ability to achieve their dreams. important element for developing their personality sphere of school life. them are not able to devote quality time towards conditions, congested homes and the emotional illiterate or poorly schooled and hence are not able motivate the Dalit children to stay at school and Dr. Ambedkar Cultural Academy (DACA) has quality education and overall formation and to Stiftung Jesuiten Weltweit, Zürich has established Tirunelveli, Tuticorin and Virudhunagar). These

and that too, only to the Government schools or infrastructures, less number of teachers and lack The participation of Children in co-curricular and self-confidence. However, the Dalit children in They miss suitable environment for studies not only studies at their homes due to various limitations. stress brought about by poverty keep the children to accompany them in their pursuit of knowledge. pursue their education. resolved to impart the basic education to Dalit reduce their dropout rates. To achieve this task, 100 Evening Study Centers (ESCs) across 6 districts six districts are clubbed under four zones namely

Dalit children in rural India particularly in the remote

Objective of the project:

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The primary goal of these centres is to give quality self-esteem to continue their studies and compete. All our plans and activities for ESCs are based on In order to motivate the Children to excel trainings. In the area of Personality Development, Our Children also play a significant role in our children have planted nearly 7000 tree saplings living conditions of people in their villages through enrolled so far and are making use of the centres. Over the past 3 years, our

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primary education to rural Dalit children by providing with other privileged children. To achieve this goal, these three objectives. academically, we do activities such as Science we plan and execute various activities such as Community Development by helping to eradicate across more than 80 villages. Now these trees are Children's Parliament (CP). to sit, study and do their home-works. Each centre children have planted nearly

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them with suitable ambiance to study and develop. DACA has formulated 3 dimensional developments. A few activities of the academic year: Exhibition, Quiz Contest, different awards for 'Thalirgalin Purachikathir', a Children's Magazine, plastics and clean common places in the villages. regularly watered and well-monitored by them. Our Each Zone is coordinated effectively by a Zonal has a well-motivated animator to accompany the 7000 tree saplings across more

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various life skills and to motivate them to increase namely Education, Personality and Community. 2024-2025: achievers, apart from their regular classes and Annual Days and observance of important days. We are pleased to report that over the past 3 years, children have taken significant steps to improve the Coordinator. Nearly 3000 Dalit Children have been children in their studies. than 80 villages.

Our Gratitude to...

The project is supported by the generosity of our friends from Stiftung Jesuiten

Weltweit, Switzerland.

Last year, the children representatives of our ESCs from 67 villages participated in the Grama Sabha meetings and presented petitions addressing various basic needs of their communities. We are proud to share that in 37 villages, the petitions of our children were accepted and fulfilled. These actions of our children have been widely appreciated among the people.

Every year DACA honors and motivates its best animators and coordinators with various awards. Last academic year alone, nearly 36 animators were awarded with the Dr. Ambedkar Awards for their outstanding performances in the community development programs. Additionally, two animators received the Founder Award and DACA Award for their noble contribution towards the holistic development of the children. Mr. Uthayamoorthy, the Coordinator of Muthukulathur

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Zone, was honored with the DACA SUDAR Award for his overall performance in the growth of the children and development of the villages.

I am S. KAVIYARASAN from Anna Nagar Centre of Sathur zone, and I am currently doing 9th class. DACA's study centre has brought many positive changes in my life. I have been a student at DACA centre for the past three years. It has helped me complete my homework regularly.

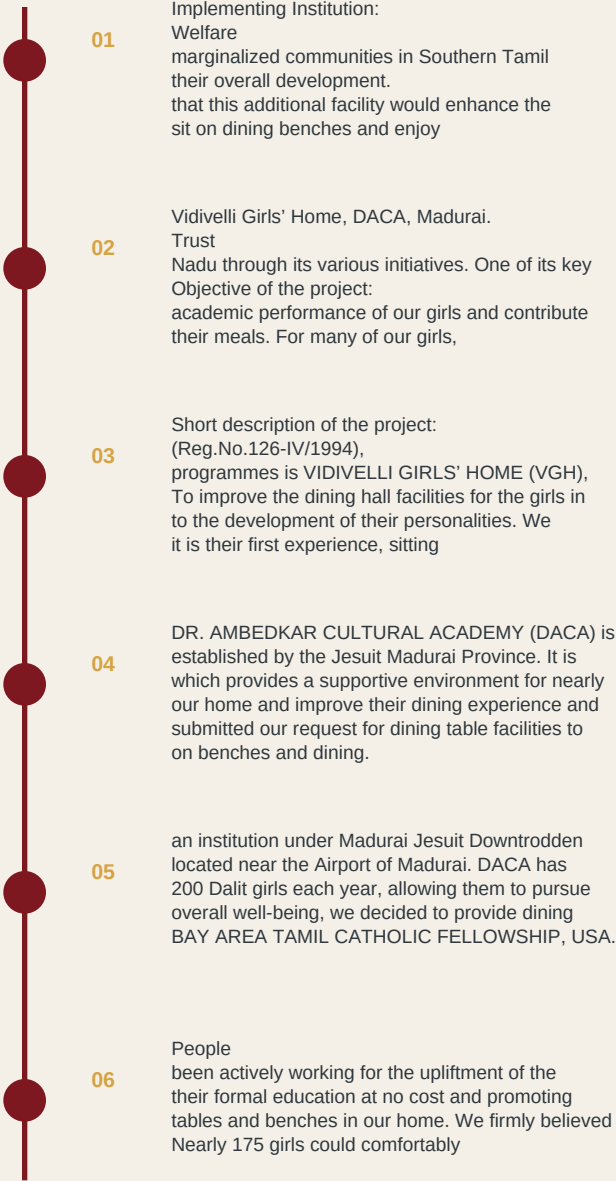
Whatever opportunities I miss in school, I get it in DACA centre. I am very proud to be a part of the DACA centre.

Mr. S. Kaviyarasan

I am MS. DEVIBALA, the Animator of Sellur Centre in Muthukulathur zone. I have been working as Animator here for the past 4 years. Initially, I focused solely on teaching textbook lessons to my children. However, through interactions with other Animators, I realized that my mission extends beyond just providing textbook knowledge, it also includes imparting life-oriented knowledge. I am always grateful to my fellow animators and

Chapter 04

Equipping the dining hall facilities



SASIKALA A., Class XII: Earlier, when I saw people sitting on benches

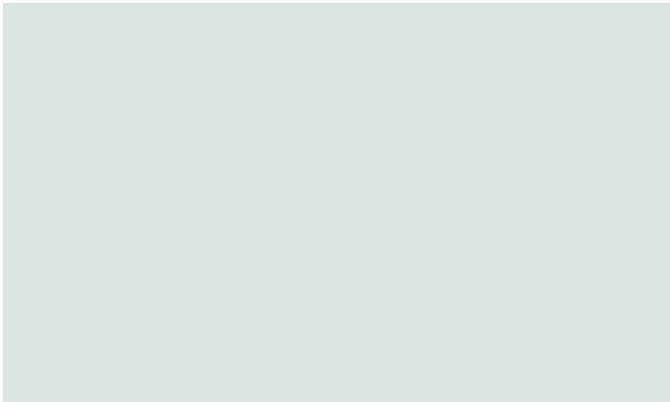
and enjoying their meals, I wished to have such experience in my life too. At the time, I realized it was a dream that felt out of reach for me. However, today in my home, I am very happy to sit on the dining benches and enjoy my meals. I feel wonderful, and my thoughts are filled with joy and gratitude. I am truly thankful to our kind benefactors in the Bay Area Tamil Catholic Fellowship.

Ms. Sasikala A

Our Gratitude to...

We are grateful to Mr. John Eugene Edward and all the dedicated members of the BAY AREA TAMIL CATHOLIC FELLOWSHIP for their generous support in providing dining facilities to our home.

ANITHA J., Class VI: I used to sit on the floor to have my meals at home,

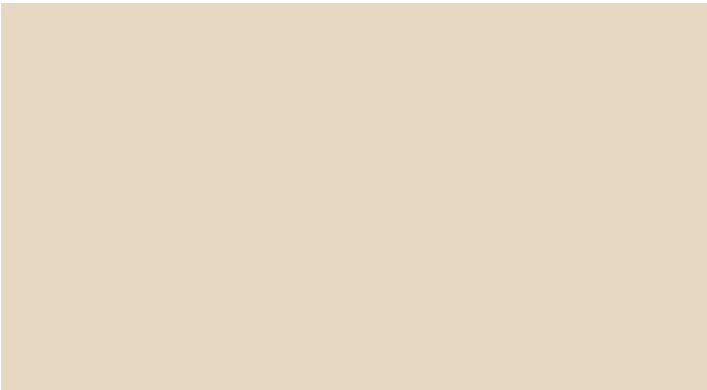
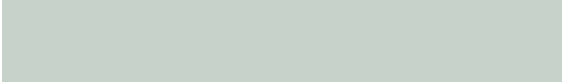


benches while having my meals, and now my wish has been fulfilled. It was truly a joyful surprise for me. On behalf of my friends, I would like to express our sincere gratitude to our generous benefactors.

Ms. Anitha J

THE APPROVAL OF THE PROJECT:

The project was generously approved by Mr. John Eugene Edward, the President of the Bay Area Tamil Catholic Fellowship, located at 5456 Midday Common, Fremont, CA 94555. The approval was granted on May 16, 2024 and immediately we began implementing the project of establishing dining facilities in our Home.



Chapter 05 Vidivelli Girls' Home – A Temple of Empowerment

Vidivelli Girls' Home, supported continuously by Jesuitenweltweit in Nuremberg, Germany, has been

The aim of our Home is to enable the deprived and the downtrodden children to live a dignified life, to instil life skills.

leading roles in organizing the events. Various departments operate within our home, including Education, but also experience a significant boost in their self-esteem.

trainings, we also find that games are fantastic ways to teach Children discipline, self-regulation,

Empowering Girl Children Through Education

"Education is the indispensable means for

enabling girls to grow into

Bank emphasized the importance of girls' education, noting that failing

million girls are out of school globally'. It is

clear that girls' education

marginalized and economically poor

communities in Tamil

girls through various programmes such as

Vidivelli Girls'

providing an excellent milieu for Dalit girls to grow in every aspect of their lives for the past 28 years.

in them a hope of a bright future and to empower them work for a just social order. To achieve this goal,

The unique feature about our home is that all the events and programs at our home are meticulously

Art and Culture, Health, Food and Kitchen,

Garden, Games, Notice Board and etc. are led

by our girls. By

Periodically Special trainings and motivational talks in view of mental, physical, social,

emotional and

life-values, etc.

In his address to delegates from the

International Catholic Conference of

active and responsible women, proud and

happy in their everyday

to let girls finish their education could cost the

world as much as \$30

significantly impacts both individual growth

and societal development.

Nadu, Dr. Ambedkar Cultural Academy

(DACA) with its

Home, Evening Study Centres and Summer

Camps, etc. to

Currently, 107 girls reside in the home and attend nearby schools and colleges.

our Home provides an excellent ambience to our girls, wherein they equip themselves with knowledge and

planned and executed by our girls, with guidance and consultation from staff and

Jesuits. Our girls take on

taking on these leadership roles and

organizing events, our girls not only develop

valuable leadership skills

spiritual wellness of our children have been

arranged for our girls. Apart from Educational and Cultural

- Fr. Vargheesh Antony, S.J.,

Guiding (ICCG) in Rome in June 2015, Pope

Francis (2013-2025) stated,

lives." On July 12, 2018, during the celebration

of Malala Day, the World

trillion lost in earnings and productivity

annually, yet more than 130

Knowing the importance of education in the

lives of socially

motto 'Knowledge is Power', provides

opportunities for Dalit

pursue their dreams through education.

Vidivelli Girls' Home, supported continuously by Jesuitenweltweit in Nuremberg, Germany, has been

M. SWETHA PRIYADHARSHINI, 12th

Class: I have been able to consistently

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do well in my studies because of DACA and its dedicated efforts towards point that boosted my confidence. I chose the Computer Science N. YUVASRI, College II Year: The DACA campus has given me great my studies, thanks to the eco-friendly atmosphere of DACA campus of securing a government job. I also receive financial support for both state and national levels that they are second (SDAT) to represent our state in the national level We firmly believe in the words of Fr. Antony Raj, S.J., Children of modern society and will be able to

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our education. It has been three years since I joined DACA. When I first group for my higher secondary studies. Now, in my 12th standard, opportunity to excel in my studies. I am a first-generation learner, and the educational support it provides—such as computers, a my education, which is a big help. to none. It is to be noted that Bhavatharani, Taekwondo tournament which was held in 2017 'If Dalits only get an opportunity, they will reach assert themselves (Interview in The Hindu on 27 in every aspect of their lives.

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came here, I was just an average or even below-average student. I am aiming high and determined to score more than 550. currently pursuing B.Sc. Physics. Earlier, I had a lot of fear and was not library, well-equipped classrooms, and dedicated staff. All these Ms. N. Yuvasri a student of class 6th of our Home was selected in Telangana state, wherein she won gold and the promised land where there is no bondage July, 2011). Today our Home has been regarded by Testimonies...

4

However, scoring 427 marks in my 10th public exam was a turning Ms. M. Swetha Priyadharshini able to perform well in academics. But now, I am able to do well in resources constantly motivate me to aim high and pursue my goal Most of our girls had proved in different competitions by the Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu brought laurels to our home and state. and servitude. Wherein they will be the fearless the common people as a temple of enlightenment

Chapter 06 Promoting and Advocating the Rights of Nature by

widows and students

Implementing Institution:

Kalangarai Social Animation Centre, founded in 2005 at Nagapattinam, launched this new environmental project in the 20th year of its establishment. Its priority groups are widowed and single women, rural youth, and rural school-going children.

Objectives:

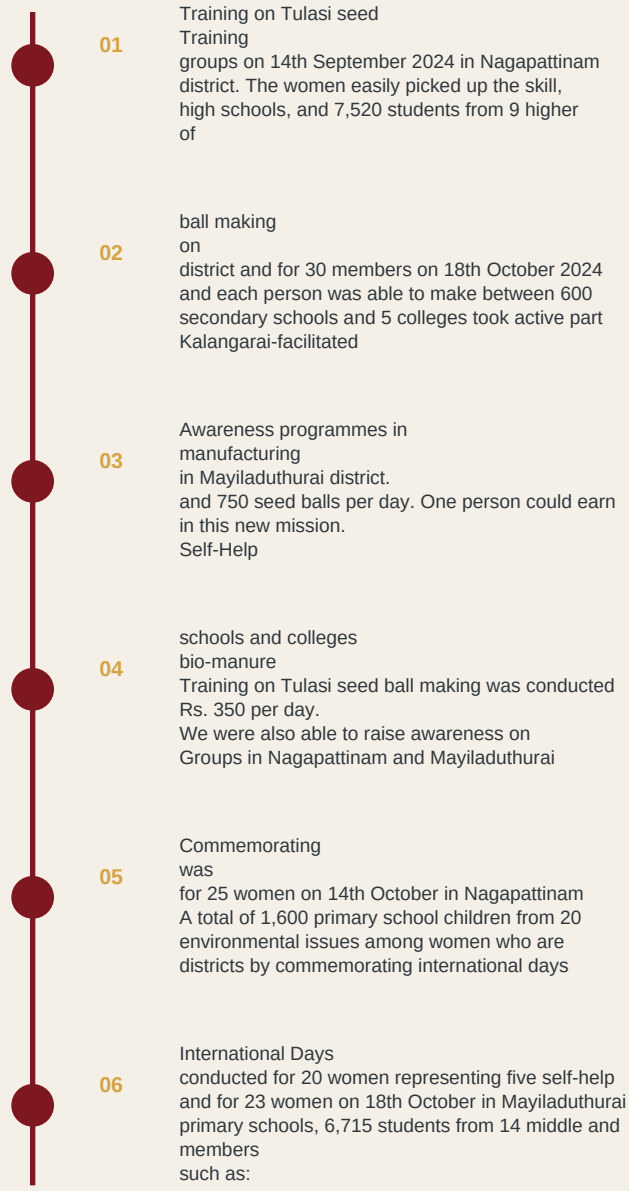
The main objective of this project is to promote environmental sustainability by involving school and college students in growing Tulasi plants, while simultaneously providing economic support to widows involved in producing seed balls, nurturing Tulasi plants, and making organic manure. This initiative not only encourages ecological awareness among youth but also empowers widows with meaningful livelihood opportunities. The project aims to combat global warming and climate change by encouraging the cultivation of Tulasi (Holy Basil) plants across four districts — mainly Nagapattinam and Mayiladuthurai, and secondarily Thanjavur and Thiruvavur districts in Tamil Nadu. Launching of the project:

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The activities include:

Providing skills to women to manufacture bio-manure and Tulasi seed balls and to nurture Tulasi saplings,
Raising awareness, inspiring action, and highlighting critical issues affecting the planet among students in schools and colleges situated in the Cauvery Delta districts and among women in self-help groups facilitated by Kalangarai, and
Giving training to women and the public interested in promoting bio-organic

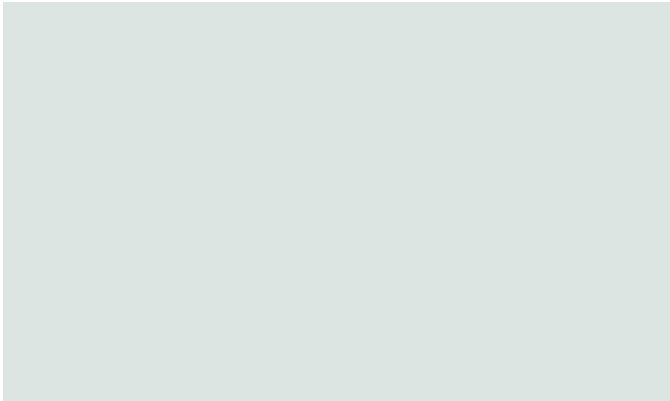
Training on bio-manure:



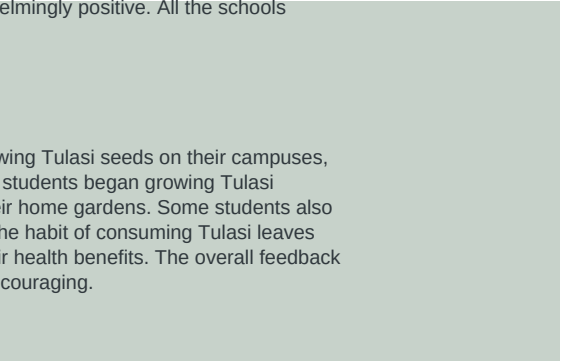
Trainings

A two-day training was organized in June 2025 for those interested in opening bio-organic shops. 20 women entrepreneurs participated in the training, and two self-help groups opened organic shops. Another three one-day trainings were conducted in three blocks for 20 women in each block who were interested in supplying organic food items like organic vegetables, millets, country chicken, country eggs, A2 milk, and bio-manure to organic shops in April 2025. Finally, two one-day trainings were conducted for the public on the importance of organic foods in July 2025. Around 50 persons, including men, actively participated in these trainings.

Schools



was overwhelmingly positive. All the schools appreciated our endeavour. Many schools reported sowing Tulasi seeds on their campuses, and several students began growing Tulasi plants in their home gardens. Some students also developed the habit of consuming Tulasi leaves daily for their health benefits. The overall feedback was very encouraging.



Additional income to widows

Organic shops
ball production, collectively earning Rs. 2 lakhs income, improved produced and distributed to 14,000 students across SHG opened
■Mrs. V. Devi, from the Kurinji SHG, opened
• women continue to receive produce supplies
Our Sincere Gratitude to...
I am Mrs. V. Devi, wife of late Mr. Venkatesan, aged 39, and a widow sons and a daughter. After joining the Kurinji Widows SHG, with the me with financial support through the Jesuiten Weltweit Project. women from my SHG to cultivate organic vegetables to supply
Mrs. V. Devi

Seed ball making during the project period. This provided substantial contributing financial stability for their families. schools and colleges in the project area. members organic shops:
Chandran Organic Shop in Thinnunagiri on
■Mrs. Irudhaya Rosary opened her organic shop from fellow SHG members who cultivate The project is supported by the generosity of our friends from Stiftung Jesuiten belonging to the Kurinji Self-Help Group at Vedharajapuram. Three years guidance and encouragement of Kalangarai, I opened Chandran These funds were used for renting and renovating the shop and my shop. Through this initiative, both the women farmers and Testimonies...

A total of 57 women were involved in Tulasi seed additional to During the period, a total of 400,000 seed balls were Two successfully
• 16th July 2025, with support from Kalangarai. in her native village on 29th July 2025. Both organic vegetables. Weltweit, Switzerland. ago, my husband passed away due to illness, leaving me with two Organic Shop at Thinnunagiri on 16 July 2025. Kalangarai provided purchasing stock at wholesale prices. Kalangarai also assisted six I benefit economically.

Organic shops

Chapter 07 Transforming the youth

1

- Fr. Kulandaisamy, S.J., term social action. In India, widows are often viewed as symbols of misfortune, a perception deeply rooted. Responding to the challenges of widows and single women, Kalangarai was simultaneously relentless in section of society. This alternative phenomenon sowed a firm confidence in socially vulnerable youths, skills, internship and job placement and also promotes self-employment through small-scale business beyond their personal growth; more significantly, educating their children and making them employable. Electrical,

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Arising from the 2004 Tsunami relief efforts, Kalangarai, a Jesuit Social Action Centre in Madurai Province, in religious and superstitious beliefs that foster their dehumanisation. Kalangarai has consistently stood in empowering the youth. As a result of this, Kalangarai incorporated the new emergence from the academic who are not so vibrant in systematic academics but are interested in developing the necessary skills. The development to alleviate poverty. will improve their financial stability. Thus, in September 2005, Kalangarai formally started St. Joseph's

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under the Nagai Jesuit Public Charitable Social and Educational Trust in Nagapattinam district, Tamil Nadu, solidarity with widows and single women, working toward their empowerment and the protection of their discipline — the formation of community college, pioneered by Rev. Dr. S. Xavier Alphonse, S.J., in the year community college, aiming at gradual social change through building human resources in communities. Kalangarai took this alternative education system since the focus of its mission is on the marginalised Community College, offering

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was established in 2005 to advocate for the rights and dignity of widows and single women through long-socio-political, economic, and cultural rights. 1995 in India. The community college movement is committed to imparting skill training for the marginalized and forming responsible citizens through empowerment and capacity building, includes life-skills, work-sections of society. Moreover, empowering the widows and making them self-sustainable extends
i)
iii) practical training, partnerships with industries, and

The college empowered me with technical knowledge while nurt

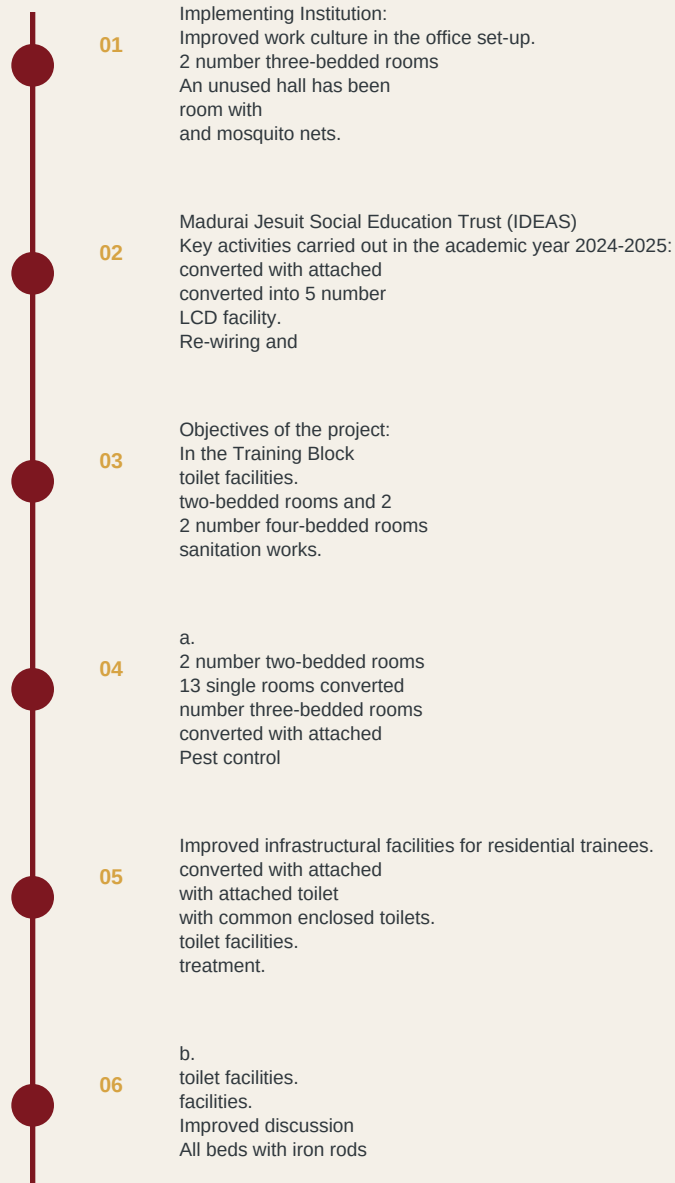
Today, I am working in a computer centre earning Rs. 8,000 every month. I am very grateful to St. Joseph's Community College for the education, support, and encouragement that I received. Despite its long-standing commitment to equipping these young people, Kalangarai has nevertheless found a vacuum in its journey. India's demographic potential is enormous, with over 62% of its population in the working-age group, leading to rising unemployment rates, even among educated youth. Therefore, empowering a youth with certain skills alone will not necessarily open more opportunities in the job sectors. In response to this reality, Kalangarai began a venture into the multi-skilled technician education, which serves young individuals to thrive in a competitive global economy. In June 2024, the Jesuit Madurai Province permitted Kalangarai to establish the Multi-Skill Technician Centre (MSTC) in the same Community College campus. This

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India.
This
centre
gives
a
45-day intensive residential program that includes training in:
i)
Refrigeration and Air-conditioning,
ii)
Electricals,
iii)
Welding,
iv) Wiring,
v)
Plumbing,
vi) Fire-fighting systems,

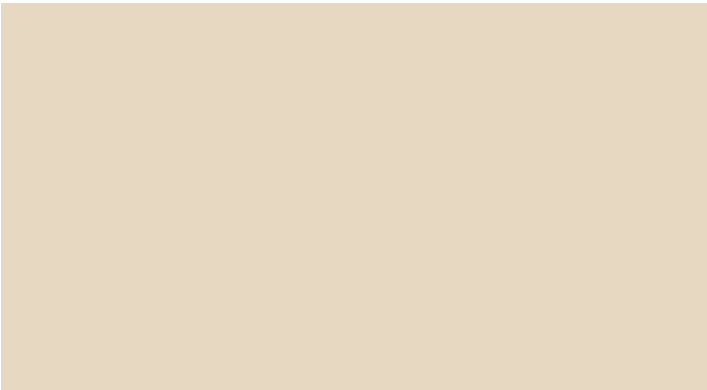
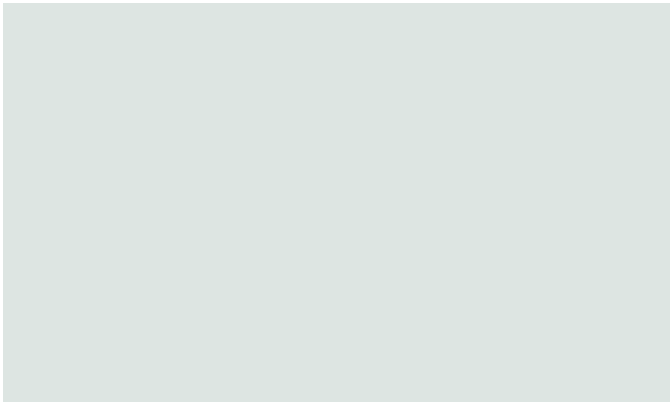
Chapter 08

Improved Infra-structural facilities for Trainees



Change of water supply system

and renovation of the water tank.
Flooring with tiles, renovation
of toilets, repair of doors and
windows, interior and exterior
colour washing.
In the Administrative Block:
Re-wiring and sanitation works.
In the Jesuit quarters and
common works:
A



storeroom
converted
into
a
living room.
Laying of Paver block.
Main gate repair and sheet roof for
the generator.
Additional CCTV cameras.
Improved drinking water facility.

Our Sincere Gratitude to...

The project was supported by the generosity of our friends from and vibrant. All the buildings have been well-maintained and newly environment, with safe, comfortable accommodation for trainees. It water and well-maintained dining facilities are available. helps participants feel dignified and respected. The improved digital spaces and a refreshing outside environment adds to the overall well-welcoming and professional space for coordination and support. and renewed energy to our social work mission. The rooms were hot, and mosquitoes caused a lot of trouble, making it is cool and pleasant, allowing for peaceful and refreshing sleep. The to walk between the Ambedkar building and the Periyar building, use in all seasons. IDEAS provides accommodation and food for renovation work would encourage and attract more young people Testimonies...

Stiftung Jesuiten Weltweit, Switzerland. painted, giving the campus a very attractive and good appearance. is commendable that biodegradable and non-biodegradable waste A Staff Of Sakthi Vidiyal, Our Partner Organisation infrastructure and comfortable seating arrangements support being and inspires a sense of peace and harmony. The renovated Thanks for the opportunity to express my feelings of happiness in Sr. Roseline Mary, Fspm, Trainer And Mission Partner very uncomfortable. But now, the rooms are much improved - each has trees and plants around the buildings also create a naturally cool especially during the rainy season. Now, this has been improved participants and offers several quality transformative training to participate in various training programmes.

The training campus has been beautifully renovated and looks fresh Now the Training Centre offers a clean, peaceful, and eco-friendly are collected and managed separately, and that clean drinking The renovated training rooms provide a conducive environment that effective and engaging learning experiences. The presence of green office and staff rooms enhance working conditions, creating a witnessing the renovation of IDEAS, which brings dignity, comfort, Before the recent renovation, it used to be very difficult to sleep at night. toilet facilities, mosquito nets, and good ventilation. The environment and comfortable atmosphere. In the past, it used to be very difficult with the construction of proper walkways, making it convenient to programmes, shaping many political and community leaders. The Mr. Akilan, All India Catholic University Federation

The project was supported by the generosity of our friends from

Chapter 09 A ministry with a difference...! On 14th June, 2006, Fr. Devadoss Mudiappasamy, the then Provincial, had called me for a

1

him. I had just returned to the province from three months of treatment of my own alcoholism. After a population, the breadwinners, of the coastal communities of the state of Tamil Nadu, ravaged by the rehabilitation. Any rehabilitation plan must address the addiction problem to be effective. I happened Counselling Psychology, and theological studies, I developed a plan that begins by understanding and as a disease of mind, body and soul. They helped understanding addiction, its extent and its various consume alcohol. Alcohol consumption is higher in Tamil

2

few pleasantries, he plunged straight into business. He gave me a twin mission: to help addicts to get Tsunami of December 2004, were found to be clinically alcoholics? May be both considerations led him to to be in the right spot at the right time. He asked me to develop a plan and commissioned me to begin addressing the contemporary cultural concepts and social attitudes and use of alcohol and alcoholism. dimensions: the medical, psychological, social and spiritual dimensions of its treatment. by the National Institute of Mental Health and Neuro

3

sober and to grow in my own sobriety. Even now I don't know what prompted him to design this ministry. his decision. He, I presume, recognised the ground reality. The province had assigned four teams of Jesuits this ministry. To this end, three seminars were held and the proceedings published. What emerged from these scholarly Empirical evidence highlights significant prevalence rates of substance use disorders in the state of Tamil town, and slum populations of 28,500 people found that the average monthly expenditure on alcohol of has four colleges and eight

4

Was it just to help me consolidate my own recovery? Or the fact that the vast majority, 54.3% of the male to work among the villages ravaged by the Tsunami and had allocated a sizeable chunk of funds for their With my background in graduate studies in Social Anthropology, acquired degree of competence in exercises was that the need to present to people a contemporary scientific understanding of alcoholism Nadu. A 2021 study found that the national average for male alcoholics is 29.2%, while only 1.2% of women patients with alcohol addiction is more than their average monthly

To my happy surprise, I learned that the problem of addiction

of Venerable Pedro Arrupe. On 22nd May, 1982, Fr. Pittau read out the 'final testament'

of Pedro Arrupe: "To my spiritual sons... I bequeath the young manipulated by drugs". [cf. p. 310 & 312, 2000, George Bishop, Pedro Arrupe SJ, GSP, Ahmedabad]. It is

in honour of this gift of Pedro that the Tiruchi centre is named Arrupe Health Enclave

for Alcohol and Drug Deaddiction (AHEAD).

The 12-steps-programme that we have adopted resembles closely the Spiritual Exercises of our Founder Ignatius of Loyola. The Ignatian principle of "tantum quantum" throws a spiritual light upon the phenomenon of addiction itself. Seeking God's will and praying for the strength to carry out His will should be the goal of all human endeavour.

In a meeting of our patients, one witnessed: "If I and my family

“

are alive today, it is because of the Jesuit Ministry!" 60% of our patients recover and continue to be in touch with us. They repair their rundown houses, dress better and their children do better in their studies. One telling sample will be of a family: the eldest is successfully completing his graduate studies in data science and the younger one is an A level student in a graduate programme on Artificial Intelligence! We have quite a collection of such success stories! It is indeed a Jesuit ministry-with a difference!

Our Gratitude to...

The project was supported by the generosity of our friends from Stiftung Jesuiten Weltweit, Switzerland and Jesuit Missions-UK, London.

Chapter 10

Training

Students in

Organic

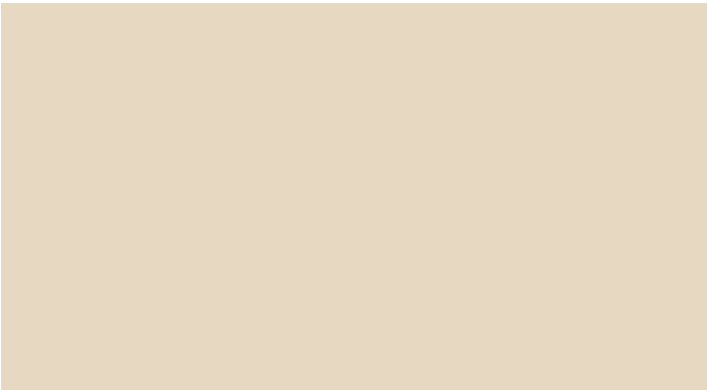
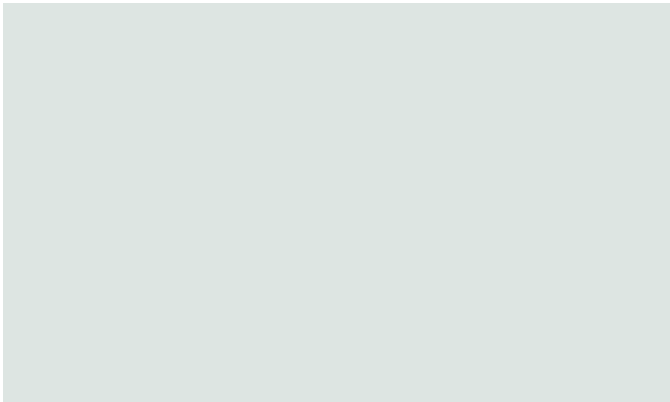
Farming and



Several key activities were undertaken. The land

was divided into around 20 distinct blocks based on soil characteristics for plant cultivation and animal husbandry. The blocks include:

- Xerophyte Garden
- ■ Podhigai Garden (Kaani Tribe –Medicinal Plants)
- Fruit Garden
- Medicinal Tree Garden
- Herbal Garden
-



ponds. An additional pond was created to store water for fish culture and agricultural irrigation. For organic farming purposes, various bio-fertilizers and bio-pesticides

It is well planned and established garden with plants of different varieties. It is much

appreciated. It is good for students and nature.

Today is a very special day for all of us students and faculty. We saw very rare and This is a very good initiative. I am sure in the future it will be noted as a centre Our Gratitude to...

This is an excellent spot for protecting our nature. It is an innovative initiative. We will Mr. F. Arockiasamy, (Vickramasingapuram) Ms. S. Esther

Dr. Ravichandran (V. Senior Preservation Assistant, Botanical Survey Of endangered species in Xavier Solai. of excellence.

The project was supported by the generosity of our friends from visit again. Xavier Solai is very informative for the teachers of Cambridge school; It is very useful for all the learners and it's an important livelihood opportunity. Testimonies...

India, Coimbatore)

Dr. V. Irudayaraj, (Department Of Botany, St. Xavier's College)

Fr. L. John Peter Arulanandam. (St. Joseph's College, Tiruchirappalli)

Jesuiten Weltweit, Nuremberg.

We really grateful for this park.

Therefore, all those interested should continue to attend in future.

appreciated. It is good for students and nature.

Chapter 11 Eco-Consciousness:

Need of the hour Eco-consciousness is the awareness of environmental matters and the interconnectedness

1

actions with the natural world, leading us to a feeling of responsibility, respect and concern to do something view to promote sustainability and protect the environment. and destruction. People living today not only have to consider our own well-being, but also the well-being of our future the environment. generates awareness and guides us to act. abused the environment and contributed to its deterioration through various harmful activities. Hence, relation to the environment. We have to make the right choices in order to preserve the human race from

2

proactively to safeguard the environment. Eco-consciousness is founded on the realization of the intrinsic worth of the environment with all its living Eco-consciousness forbids us to abuse natural and biological resources. It motivates us to work for clean generations. Our impact on the environment is strongly affected by how we view our earthly home. Eco-consciousness is very important in today's context as the effect of environmental deterioration is Eco-consciousness drives us to realize that all these years, the environment has contributed to the well-

3

This is linked to our understanding of the environmental impact of our actions, a strong desire to care for beings and non-living things. It makes us respect, appreciate, protect and regenerate the environment. and healthy environment. It emerges from the realization that the environment is the heart of our intellectual, Eco-consciousness prompts us to re-discover our roots, our interconnectedness and our independence in being felt all over the world through climate change, global warming, natural disaster, loss of biodiversity, being of humans not only by

4

the good of the environment, and taking steps to act on those issues which harm the environment with a It evokes a love for nature. It enables us to use the gifts of nature judiciously by avoiding pollution, waste moral, aesthetic, physiological, psychological and spiritual wellness. the cosmos. It re-awakens our conscience in relation to our duties and responsibilities to all that exists in pollution, deforestation etc. We can no longer be mere onlookers. It brings about a shift in paradigm which with ecstatic beauty, grandeur, awe and wonder; however, due to human greed, in recent years,

botanical pesticides like PONNEEM; biological methods to con

training was given to the farmers to prepare organic products for their own use.

2.

■Through another project we developed Xavier Solai (agro, eco, biodiversity park) to promote Agro-Tourism for the benefit of students, farmers and the public. This project was supported by Jesuiten Weltweit, Switzerland.

■The project was established in the farm located in Irudayakulam, Tirunelveli District in 10 hectares of land named as XAVIER SOLAI. An artificial fish pond has been established, and a greenhouse has been constructed to nurture saplings. Various gardens have been developed, including those for xerophyte plants, medicinal trees, a fruit tree garden, a medicinal herb garden, and plots for vegetables, pulses, and cereals, all of which are being carefully maintained organically. A timber garden has also been established. All plants have name boards. A walking pathway has been created for viewing whole Xavier Solai and aquatic birds.

■In the realm of organic farming, essential bio-fertilizers and

“

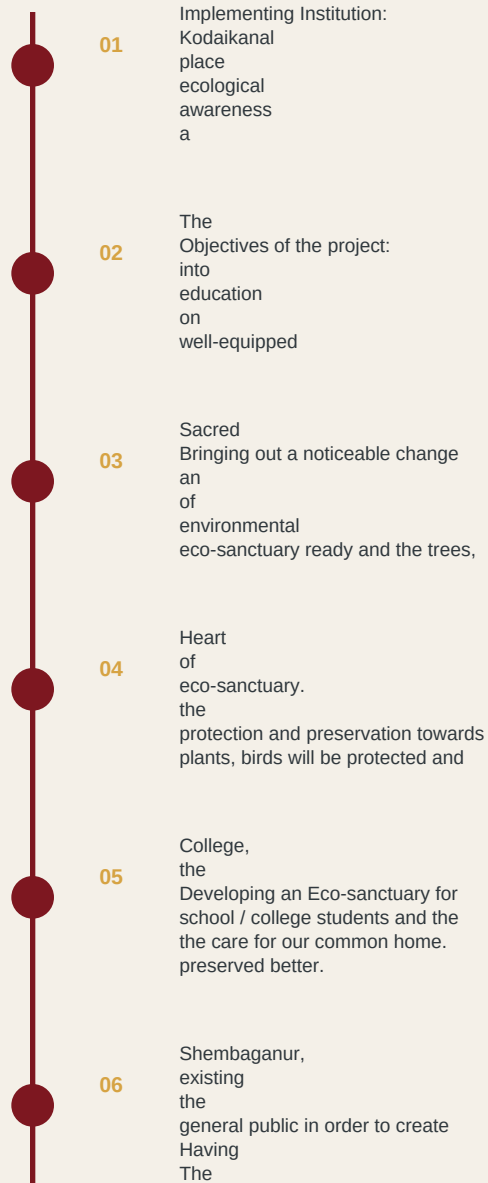
■Through another project, we trained students to be agents of environmental protection and organic farming. This project was supported by Jesuiten Weltweit, Germany.

■We fostered environmental awareness among students in local schools on ecological literacy and sustainable practices. Nearly 10,000 students across various schools were given training. The awareness program covered a comprehensive range of topics central to understanding environmental systems. These included the interdependence of plants, animals, and humans; the roles of consumers and decomposers; the importance of natural resources and diverse habitats; fossil formation; the impact of pollution and deforestation; and the critical role of biodiversity.

■Additionally, the sessions explored soil health, the significance of microbes, and sustainable agricultural practices such as crop rotation, intercropping, mulching, vermicomposting, natural plant growth regulators, and the use of botanical pesticides like PONNEEM. Students were also introduced to biological pest control methods and strategies to manage human-wildlife conflict. Furthermore, the students were guided on how to

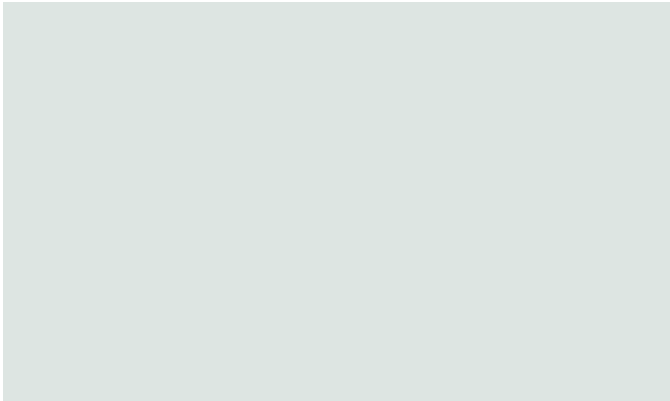
Chapter 12

Developing an Eco-sanctuary

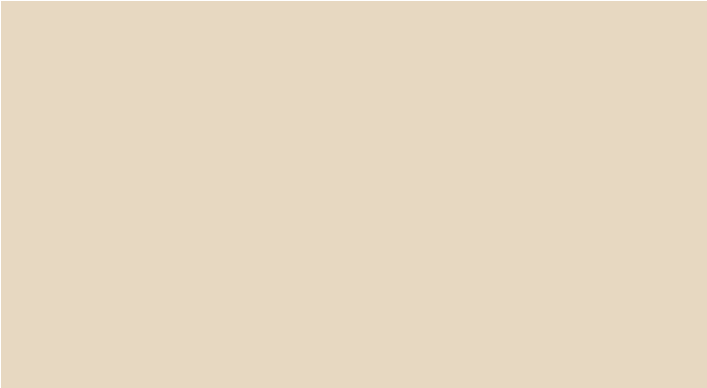


Key activities carried out in the academic year 2024-2025

- ■Regular workshop and programmes are organized for inculcating in the hearts and minds of the students and general public the importance of caring for our common home by conducting environmental awareness programs in collaboration with the ANGLADE Institute of Natural History, which has been serving the student community for many decades.
- ■Pathway road formation is done by mending and repairing the dilapidated roads for 2 k.m. along with alley landscaping carried out with three different experts' team.
- ■Removing bush (a stunted, low-branched tree that typically grows in



was made by the forest officials who paid a visit to the campus. It was highly commended that the planting of new trees, crotons, plants and Epipremnum aureum was very futuristic initiative.



Chapter 13 Empowering the Children & Women of Dalit and Tribal communities

of Kodai Hills through education, People's Education for Action in Kodaikanal (PEAK) Trust, Sacred Heart College, Shembaganur, Kodaikanal. their social, educational, and economic empowerment. Many children and women in these communities Through its initiatives, the organization promotes education, savings, self-confidence, and leadership and strengthen their role in society. This report presents the main activities, outcomes, and challenges of Monitoring drop-out children Building constant Facilitating the study of children and helping them to understand organizing Tribal & health and hygiene, a movement. their studies. children – writing,

awareness building and capacitation Short Description of the project: face challenges that limit their growth. To address this, PEAK focuses on education, awareness and among children and women. The project "Empowering the Children & Women of Dalit and Tribal communities 2024–2025. and making efforts to send them awareness - clearing doubts about lessons, basic concepts. Dalit Women. legal rights, and Ensuring that all children of Unearthing the speaking, drawing, and

Implementing Institution: PEAK has served the Dalit and Tribal communities of the Kodaikanal Hills for over three decades, working for capacity building. of Kodai Hills through Education, Awareness Building, and Capacitation" aims to develop their potential Objective of the project back to school. on cleanliness. helping them do their homework, Capacitation and Building awareness on organizing women as the target villages pursue hidden talents of leadership qualities.

of Kodai Hills through education,

In the villages of Kodaikanal, many Dalit and Tribal

1

families live in small houses. The children do not have established Evening Coaching Centres for the in the evening. Most classes are held in community writing, and speaking practice in both Tamil and songs, and social awareness songs. In addition,

-
-
-
-
-

Dr. Key activities carried out in the academic

2

a supportive environment to study at home, and children studying in the local village schools. halls, while in villages without community halls, English. They help students complete homework the play-way method is used to teach basic

- Children's Parliament.
- Training Sessions for ECC Teachers.
- Children's Day Celebration.
- Human Rights Day.
- Annual Ambedkar's year 2024-2025

3

their parents often lack an academic background At present, there are 15 evening coaching centres. On rented houses are used. and review lessons taught in schools. Teachers also mathematics and vocabulary.

- -
 -
 -
- Day
Birth
Evening Coaching Centres

4

to guide them in their studies. To address this, PEAK weekdays, the classes run for one and a half hours In these centres, teachers provide listening, reading, guide them in learning general knowledge, action Other Activities in Each Village

- Monthly Meetings with ECC Staff.
- Magazine – Sigaram Thodu.
- Dr. Ambedkar's Death Anniversary.
- Pongal Celebration. and Anniversary Celebrations. (ECC) in Kodaikanal Villages

Women today stand as equals to men in society.

They have overcome many barriers and entered every field; space, research, science, technology, policing, politics, aviation, and transportation. Their achievements are on par with men, bringing pride to women everywhere.

For the past 35 years, the PEAK organization has been carrying out various initiatives for women's development, including:

1. ■Encouraging small savings among women,
2. ■Celebrating International Women's Day every year,
3. ■Forming self-help groups,
4. ■Conducting leadership training, and
5. ■Helping women start their own businesses.

“

been formed; 23 in the upper hill region and 5 in the lower hill region. These groups have opened bank accounts and have been saving regularly for two years. In total, there are 350 women in these groups, while three additional villages have around 120 women participating in savings groups.

Self Help Groups
for Women
Challenges

- ■Some students are irregular in attending the classes and show a lack of interest in studying after school.
- ■Parents often do not understand the value of education and fail to encourage their children

Our Sincere Gratitude to...

01

We express our sincere gratitude to the Jesuit Conference of South Asia petty shops increasing their family income. These opportunities have helped women become financially

- Some women who receive loans fail to repay them, making it difficult to extend loans to others, since
- In some cases, the savings amount is very small compared to the loan requested,

02

and the Conference Development Office for supporting this project. independent, marking not only their personal growth but also the success of PEAK's empowerment efforts. the programme works on a revolving fund system. about their repayment capacity. Conclusion

03

PEAK also provides interest-free loans to help members to start small businesses. So far, 135 women This progress stands as a powerful example of women's empowerment. It is no exaggeration to say that

- Outcome of the project

04

have received loans of Rs. 15,000 or Rs. 20,000 each. This support has enabled them to lease agricultural the PEAK organization has been a guiding force in supporting women's growth and development. ■ Many women limit themselves to saving and do not actively participate in development programmes

05

land, buy livestock such as goats, cows, and horses, and purchase seeds and fertilizers to cultivate crops Challenges aimed at building confidence and social identity. students in Grihini and 28 students in other hostels) and 247 students in Evening Coaching Centres are

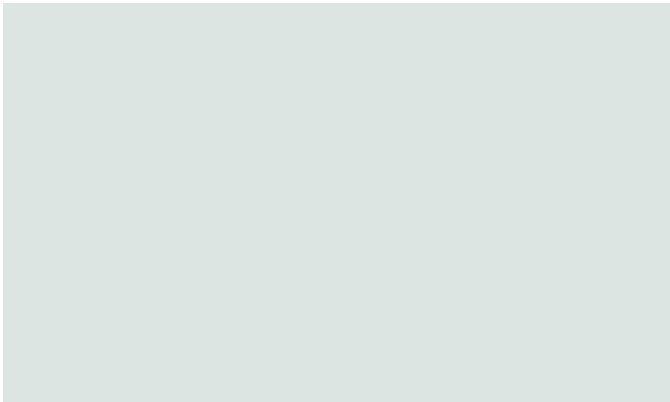
06

like peas, garlic, and potatoes. Some women have even opened small restaurants, grocery stores and

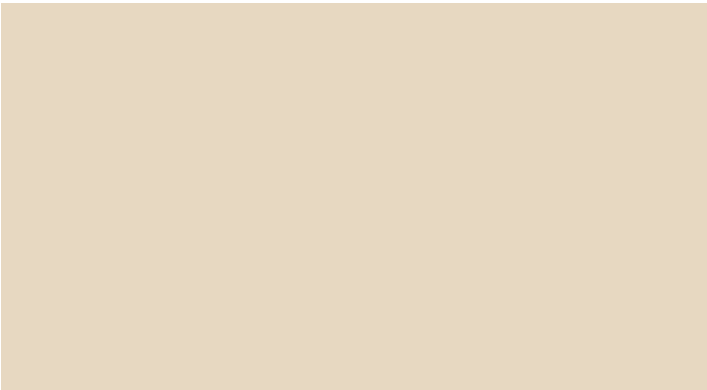
-
- supported by PEAK Trust. experience. Infrastructure improvements such as the Inigo Dining Hall have further

Chapter 14 Renovation of INIGO Boys' Home

in Kodaikanal
Implementing Institution:
PEAK Trust, Sacred Heart College, Shembaganur, Kodaikanal, Tamil Nadu, India
Short Description of the project:
The INIGO Boys' Home has been run for the past 27 years and so far, around 1000 boys have completed their schooling using the home facilities. The director of PEAK is responsible for the running of the home. Under him, there is a Jesuit Regent who directly supervises all the activities of the hostel. Under him, there are two full-time wardens and one cook who stay with the boys all through. All these years the boys have managed to have their meals in the tin-sheeted shed, having a small kitchen and a smaller number of toilet facilities. In times of rainy season,



This project will surely benefit the poor Tribal and Dalit students in our hostels who are empowered through education. They will have enhanced infrastructural facilities and will have a better ambience to study in our hostels.
Goals Achieved by the Project:
As part of the renovation project, the new dining hall has been constructed with all the facilities required for the use of the children. As per the goal of the project, infrastructural facilities have been improved and we are grateful to Father General and for the support of FACSİ for the successful completion of the project.



Chapter 15 Shaping the present for the future of the tribal communities in Kodai hills..!

- Fr. Anthony James, S.J.
livelihoods depend on collecting pepper, honey, coffee, and medicinal herbs from the forests, selling them
security or development.
awareness among the tribes about their social, economic, and health conditions. The organization helped
Promoting Education and Awareness education. Evening coaching centres were introduced within villages to ensure continuous learning. This
Health and Nutrition Initiatives
Monthly blood tests and the distribution of nutritional medicines improved overall health standards.
Special focus was given to children, pregnant women, and the elderly — groups most affected by nutritional
emphasizing cleanliness as a key component of well-being. Home gardens were introduced to promote
Housing and Infrastructure Development
by twenty houses in Kadukuthadi and twenty-four for renovation works. The establishment of community
ongoing commitment to improving living conditions.

Among the serene hills of Kodaikanal in Dindigul district live two ancient tribes — the Paliyar and the
in small quantities, and engaging in subsistence labour. With no access to land ownership, proper housing,
Recognizing their plight, the PEAK organization (People's Education and Action in Kodaikanal) stepped
them to realize their fundamental needs, their rights, and the opportunities available to them through
Education became the cornerstone of PEAK's mission. Understanding that illiteracy made the tribal people
educational empowerment gradually enabled the tribes to navigate public systems, claim government
Malnutrition and anaemia were widespread among the Paliyar and Puliyar communities due to limited
Additionally, biannual medical camps conducted in collaboration with major hospitals ensured that those
deficiencies. Daily distribution of sprouted pulses and small grain porridges significantly improved their
organic vegetable cultivation, and waste segregation practices were implemented with the provision of
Over the years, PEAK has also made remarkable strides in improving housing and community infrastructure.
centres in J. J. Nagar (2024) and Gandhipuram (2025) further strengthened

Puliyar. For generations, these communities have lived in isolation, relying on nature for sustenance. Their
or formal education, they faced a life marked by daily survival and dependency, devoid of long-term
forward to bring transformation to these communities. Through persistent efforts, PEAK began creating
government welfare schemes.
vulnerable to exploitation, PEAK established hostels for the children and extended assistance for higher
benefits, and advocate for their rights. medical access. PEAK began addressing these issues through weekly medical assistance in each village.
in need of advanced care were identified and supported.
health conditions. The organization also conducted awareness programs on hygiene and sanitation, garbage bins.
In 2012, the organization built eight houses in Kumbaraiyur; in 2018, eighteen more in Malayakad; followed
bonding. Several new homes were built in partnership with government welfare schemes, reflecting PEAK's

- Fr. Anthony James, S.J.

Women Empowerment and Livelihood Support

1

Women have been the central focus of PEAK's empowerment efforts. The formation of seven women's Towards Self-Reliance and Political Participation They have begun acquiring essential legal documents, purchasing land, and submitting Paliyar and Puliyar communities. Its journey stands as a testament to The economically and politically powerful people made the tribals common toilets for villages? When will we get a road to for decent and dignified livelihood, PEAK is committed people in Kodai hills.

2

Self-Help Groups has fostered independence, cooperation, and entrepreneurship among tribal One of the most inspiring outcomes of PEAK's continuous involvement is the rising political petitions for basic amenities; tangible signs of empowerment and inclusion. the transformative power of education, awareness, and compassion in landless and alienated them from their own lands. After 78 years of reach the village? When will we get the land for cultivation to accompany the Tribal and Dalit communities to get

3

women. To support sustainable livelihoods, PEAK provides interest-free loans for self-employment, awareness among the tribal population. Many now actively participate in village panchayat Through its comprehensive efforts, PEAK has not only uplifted hundreds of tribal families building a just and inclusive society. Independent India, tribal people in Kodaikanal live with the and to build a house? When will we get a ration shop? their basic rights and government welfare schemes

4

encouraging families to pursue income-generating activities and achieve financial independence. meetings, articulate their needs, and even hold leadership positions in local governance. but has also ignited a spirit of self-reliance, dignity, and progress among the Accompanying with the Tribal People following questions and expectations. When will we get When will we get a bus for transport? In their struggle and thus we shape the present for the future of the

Chapter 16 Training the poor students through

Implementing Institution:

St. Joseph's Technical Institute.

A short description of the project:

St. Joseph's Technical Institute, a unit of Kalangarai Social Animation Centre, is located in Prathabaramapuram village, Kilvelur Taluk, in Nagapattinam District, a coastal region of Tamil Nadu. Two institutions function within the same campus:

i)

St. Joseph's Community College and

ii)

Multi-Skill Technician Centre (MSTC)

technical education

Kalangarai established the Community College in September 2005. The

students who enrol in the college

are generally high school or higher secondary graduates. As most of

them come from marginalized

communities, they often struggle to pay their college and hostel fees. For

students who travel from distant

areas, board and lodging facilities are provided at St. Joseph's Boys

Hostel.

St. Joseph's Community College (SJCC):

“

In June 2024, the Jesuit Madurai Province permitted Kalangarai to establish the MSTC within the campus of St. Joseph's Technical Institute. The centre aims to upgrade the technical skills of students to international standards, thereby helping them secure employment abroad or in reputed companies across India.

This intensive 60-day residential program includes training in:

i)

Refrigeration and Air-conditioning,

ii)

Electricals,

iii)

Welding,

iv) Wiring,

v)

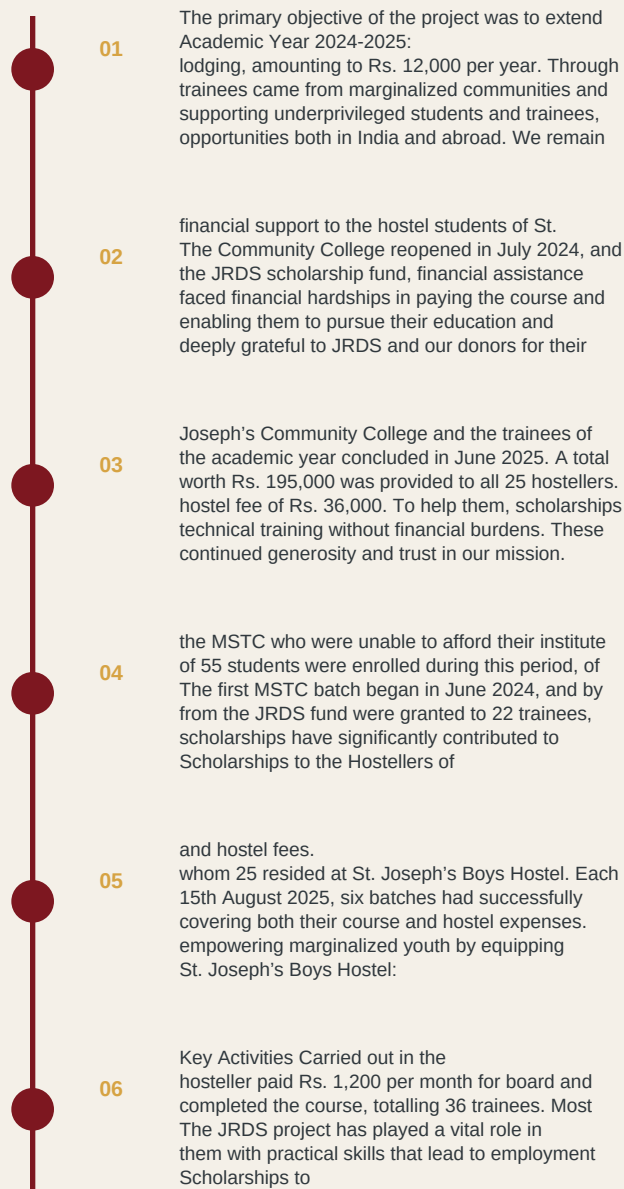
Plumbing,

vi) Fire-fighting systems,

vii) Kitchen management, and

viii) Soft skills such as computer literacy and spoken English.

Objectives of the project:

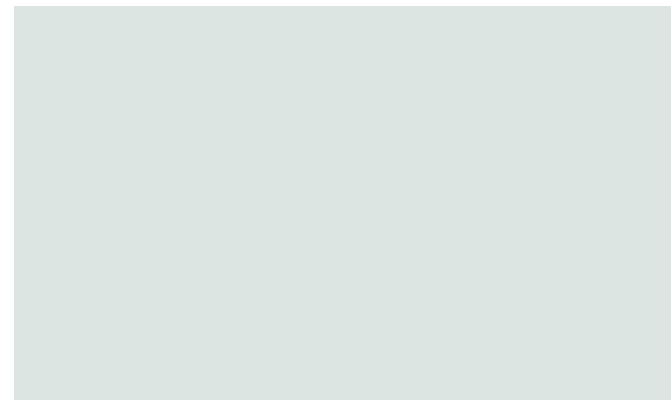


My name is Nishanth Anto. I completed my Industrial Training at Loyola

Technical Institute, Madurai. After finishing two years of my technical studies, I worked in Coimbatore for a year. However, my income was very meagre, and I struggled to manage food and accommodation. A close relative encouraged me to join the two-month intensive Multi-Skill Technician course at St. Joseph's Technical Institute, Nagapattinam. I enrolled in the first batch in June 2024. After completing the course, I secured a job as a technician at a star hotel in Chennai, where I worked for nine months. Later, I attended an online interview conducted by the Millenni Hotel, Dubai. I joined that hotel in June 2025 and now earn Rs. 51,000 per month. I am deeply grateful to all the trainers at St. Joseph's Technical Institute and to the generous benefactors who helped me become who I am today.

Mr. Nishanth Anto

I am J. Prakash. After completing my 12th standard, I worked as an



Technical Institute for this opportunity and to all the dedicated teachers who supported me.

Mr. J. Prakash

I, Leo Michael, completed my Diploma in Electronics and Communication Engineering in 2017. Afterward, I worked in a restaurant for a year with a very low salary. Although I was regular in my work, I was eventually asked to leave, even after receiving a certificate of experience. At that point, my life became miserable. During this difficult time, I learned about the MST Centre at Nagapattinam. I joined the course and completed it within two months. The program helped me acquire several skills, including basic English communication. During the training, the MST Director arranged online interviews for the

Chapter 17 Summer camps for children of widowed

women in Nagapattinam

The Boys' camp started on 1st May and ended on 6th May, and the Girls' camp began on 7th May and

The overarching aim of the six-day residential camps was not just to inform but to transform the young

transformation. The overall theme of the camps was "Thedal – Kandathum Katrathum", which means

Social Awareness:

for justice and equality). Discussions also covered gender justice, marginalization, and by a workshop on mock assembly elections and a children's parliament.

experience shows that a considerable number of widows' sons fall into drinking habits. placards promoting awareness against drug use.

began with physical exercise, yoga, meditation, and manual work. Additional sessions were

Implementing Institution:

finished on 12th May, 2025. A total of 87 children, i.e. 46 boys and 41 girls, participated in the camps.

participants into socially conscious, confident, and compassionate individuals ready to contribute

"Search – Discover – Learn".

Sessions were conducted on social analysis, Dr. B. R. Ambedkar (the principal architect women's struggles.

Drug Awareness & Prevention:

To address this, sessions were held to create awareness about the harmful effects of alcohol

Health, Wellness & Self-Discipline:

offered on personal hygiene, mental well-being, and emotional regulation, particularly for

'KALANGARAI Social Animation Centre', located in Nagapattinam, Tamil Nadu organized the summer camp.

Objectives:

to their communities. The camps provided a nurturing space for learning, expression, reflection, and

Activities Carried Out:

of the Indian Constitution), and E. V. R. Periyar (a social reformer and staunch advocate

Half a day was devoted to sessions on the Indian Constitution and citizens' rights, followed

One of the biggest threats facing Indian youth today is alcohol and drug abuse. Our

and drugs. During the girls' camp, a public rally was organized where students carried

Physical and mental health are essential for the holistic development of students. Each day the girl participants.

women in Nagapattinam

Skills for Life:

1

Students were encouraged to develop skills in personal growth. mothers. Some even express resentment or session deeply moved the students — many boys mothers to apologize for their misdeeds and to self-expression, confidence, critical thinking, celebrated creativity but also built teamwork and expression, confidence, critical

2

study methods, career guidance, and digital Empathy & Emotional Growth: speak ill of them when Kalangarai invites them were seen crying, realizing their past disrespectful express love and appreciation. and innovation. Every evening after supper, collaboration among the students. thinking, and innovation.

3

literacy. Sessions also included a few themes One of our major concerns is that many children for any training. To address this, half a day was behaviour towards their widowed mothers. That Creativity & Cultural Expression: students presented skits, music, dance, drawing, Creativity is vital for today's

4

on time management, online safety, and struggle to understand and respect their widowed dedicated to exploring the plight of widows. The same evening, several students called their Creativity is vital for today's youth as it enhances and storytelling. These performances not only youth as it enhances self-

Impacts of the Camps:

- ■The students expressed deep gratitude to Kalangarai for organizing the camp and regretted that some of their friends missed this valuable experience.
- ■Despite coming from two different districts (Nagapattinam and Mayiladuthurai), the participants developed strong bonds of friendship.
- ■The girl participants expressed happiness for learning about the POCSO Act and other laws protecting children from abuse.
- ■Many mothers reported to Kalangarai staff that their children had asked forgiveness for not understanding or respecting them and had become more responsible and obedient.
- ■Several students began supporting their mothers' small enterprises, such as helping in shops or accompanying them for business activities.
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■One joyful mother shared that after the camp, her son encouraged her to wear a nice saree to attend a social function — a gesture of renewed affection and dignity.

Conclusion:

The Summer Camps of 2025 were significant milestones in building a socially conscious, emotionally mature, and physically healthy community of children.

Through the combination of education, creativity, and activism, the students gained a deeper understanding of their world and their role in shaping a just and humane society.

Kalangarai remains committed to nurturing the next generation of leaders, critical thinkers, and advocates for social and environmental justice.

Relationship between Widowed / Abandoned Women and Kalangarai:

Kalangarai presented its ongoing programs and initiatives for the empowerment of widowed and abandoned women. Many children publicly acknowledged the positive transformation in their mothers — how they had gained self-confidence, courage, and dignity through the interventions of Kalangarai.

Our Sincere Gratitude to...

We are grateful to Mr. John Eugene Edward and all the dedicated members of the BAY AREA TAMIL CATHOLIC FELLOWSHIP for their generous support in

Chapter 18

Training

Students to

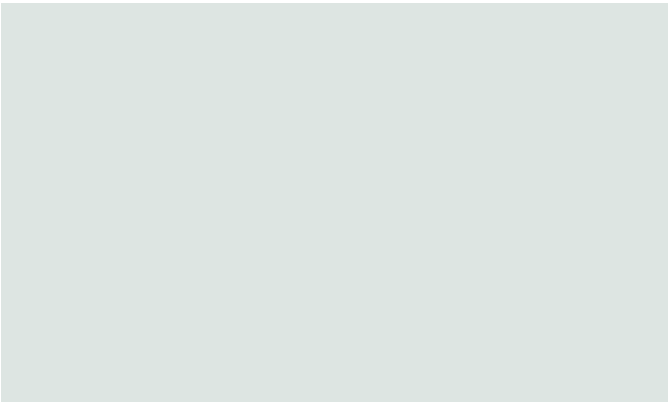
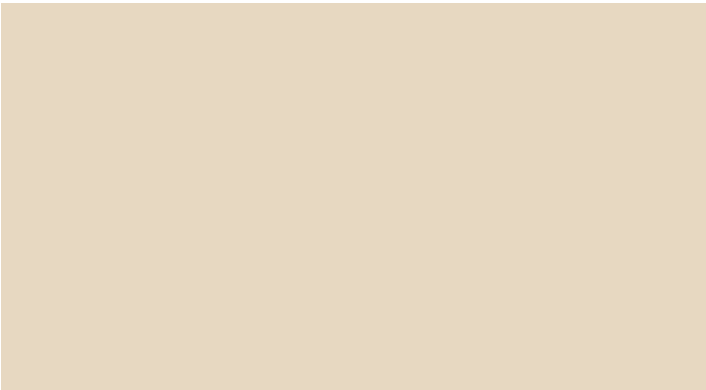
Be Agents of

Environmental



Key Activities Carried Out

■During this academic year, our team conducted a series of environmental awareness programs in local schools. The sessions focused on topics such as environmental protection, biodiversity conservation, natural farming, and pollution control. Interactive presentations and visual materials were used to explain the importance of protecting forests, wildlife, and natural resources. Students were educated on waste segregation, tree plantation, and renewable energy sources. Demonstrations were given on vermin composting, organic fertilizer preparation, and natural pest control. The program also included activities such as quiz competitions, essay writing, and drawing contests on



home. A few participants even shared their experiences highlighting how the sessions inspired them to take environmental responsibility seriously. These stories reflect the positive transformation achieved through consistent awareness and motivation.

Our Sincere Gratitude to...

The project is supported by the generosity of our friends from Stiftung Jesuiten Weltweit, Switzerland.

I really enjoyed the awareness program—it helped me understand how to protect our environment in simple ways.

Chapter 19 Renovation of Wenisch Boys' Home

Implementing Institution:

The Boys' Home, started by Fr. Turlan S.J., at St. Mary's School Campus, Madurai in 1918, was shifted to glorious service continues till this day. The boys stay on the first floor of the IHJ building and get educated in are 24 boys being trained in this building, presently known as Wenisch Boys' Home. and videos to promote catholic devotion are produced here. Storing, designing, packaging, and forwarding to increase the durability and utility of the building to continue the mission of the Institute of the Heart
It was the felt need to renovate the Wenisch Apostolic Home Building, where besides the apostolic home, the building looks very new and it will surely be in good condition for many more years to come. After the We are grateful to Father General and FACSI for the generous contribution for A vocation flows from the heart of God and

Institute of the Heart of Jesus, Wenisch Boys' Home

IHJ, Dindigul in 1964 and Fr. Paul Wenisch, S.J., became its director. The poor boys, especially the orphans our Jesuit School. Some of them who are formed in this institute have felt the call of God and joined different Fr. Paul Wenisch S.J., a French Missionary, put up the building in 1963 with the generous contribution by of the books, magazines, leaflets, etc. are done in this building. So far, there has not been any major repair of Jesus. a few other activities are carried out that are aligned with our printing ministry, and the offices of PWPN, renovation, the building looks more elegant with the new facilities. making this project a reality. blossoms in the good soil of faithful people.

Short Description of the Project:

and semi-orphans in and around Madurai & Dindigul were admitted and supported with necessities. The religious congregations. So far, nearly 550 candidates have gone through this institute and currently there Toulouse Province. PWPN, EYM and Thoothan offices are placed at this building and their leaflets, posters, or maintenance work in this building. Hence, it was a genuine and felt need that the building is renovated
Goals Achieved by the Project: EYM and Thoothan, our monthly magazine. The renovation of the building was carried out successfully and Our Sincere Gratitude to... No vocation is born of itself or lives for itself.

Implementing Institution:

Chapter 20

1

A few glimpses through the lens... the presence of Fr. Thomas Amirtham, S.J., the Provincial and Fr. Maria Joseph, S.J., the Province Treasurer.

2

Inauguration of the Province Development Office:

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The Province Development Office was inaugurated on 30 May 2024 at Maduralaya, the Jesuit Madurai

4

Provincialate. The office was blest by Fr. M. Devadoss, S.J., and opened by CA. Dr. Pannai M. Karthikeyan in

Visit of Ms. Janina Emmenegger from Jesuitenweltweit,

Switzerland:

Ms. Janina Emmenegger visited the Jesuit Madurai Province from 29 September to 6 October 2024. During

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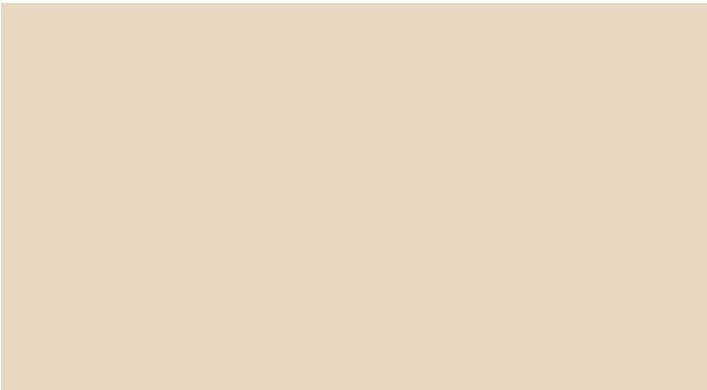
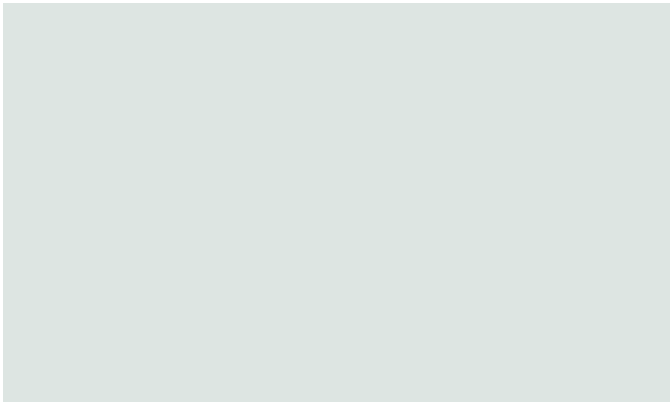
her visit, she was taken to all our social action centres where the projects are carried out. She had a rich experience of encountering the people whom we support in our target villages in and through their generosity. She interacted with our beneficiaries It was a time of strengthening our friendship.

Visit of Mr. Andre and Mrs. Helen from Nandri — Hilfe



Contact:

Province Development Director
Province Development Office
Loyola Educational Trust (LET)
Maduralaya,
Beschi Campus, Dindigul – 624 001
Mobile Number
:
+91 90431 30424
Email
:



pdd@mdusj.org
Website
:
www.mdusj.org
Book Design
Dafnil X Infantia
dafnilinfantia007@gmail.com
Visit of Mr. Marshal Pandya and Mrs. Lenka Pandya from
Cesta Domov, Slovakia:
Mrs. Lenka Pandya and Mr. Marshal Pandya along with their children
visited our Province from 20-22
February 2025 to explore the possible ways of supporting our deserving

To share the joy

of giving	Name of the Account :	LOYOLA EDUCATIONAL TRUST
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(Your donations are eligible for deduction under section	80G of the Income Tax Act,1961)	Dearest Lord.,
Teach me to be generous,	To serve you as you deserve,	To give and not to count the cost,
To fight and not to heed the wounds,	To toil and not to seek for rest,	To labor and not to look for any reward,
Save that of knowing that I do your holy will.	- St. Ignatius of Loyola	

of giving